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ECEL 2026

25th European Conference on e-Learning

Lund University, Sweden

Mini Track on Work-Integrated e-Learning

Mini Track Chair: Prakruthi Hareesh, BITS Pilani – Work Integrated Learning Programmes (WILP), India

Work-Integrated Learning (WIL) has become an increasingly important model in professional and engineering education, particularly for learners who remain embedded in full-time employment while pursuing formal qualifications. As e-learning ecosystems mature, the central challenge is no longer content delivery, but the design of learning experiences that meaningfully connect academic objectives with real workplace practice. This mini-track focuses on e-learning approaches that enable authentic work-based learning through digital platforms, tools, and pedagogies. It invites contributions that examine how online and blended learning environments can support learners in engaging with real industrial problems, organizational constraints, and professional roles while meeting rigorous academic learning outcomes. Areas of interest include the use of learning factories, remote and virtual laboratories, digital twins, and project-based learning models that integrate workplace data, processes, and tools into the learning experience. The track also encourages discussion on assessment and evaluation strategies for learning that occurs in live work contexts, including methods for capturing learning transfer, reflective practice, and professional competence development. Submissions addressing industry–academia collaboration, curriculum co-creation, faculty roles in WIL, and scalability of such models are particularly welcome. By bringing together researchers and practitioners, this mini-track aims to advance understanding of how e-learning can effectively support lifelong learning, mid-career professionals, and digitally transformed workplaces, contributing to more relevant, impactful, and sustainable professional education models.

Topics may include but are not limited to:

- Design and implementation of work-integrated e-learning models
- Digital platforms and tools for delivering industry-embedded coursework
- Project-based learning models using authentic workplace problems
- Assessment and evaluation of learning in real work contexts
- Industry–academia collaboration and curriculum co-creation for WIL



Dr. Prakruthi Hareesh serves as the Smart Manufacturing Domain Lead at BITS Pilani, Work Integrated Learning Programmes (WILP). She holds a Ph.D. in Mechanical Engineering from the University of Maryland, College Park, USA, with expertise in Mechatronics and MEMS transducer development. She has led more than 50 turnkey projects in the semiconductor and manufacturing sectors. At BITS Pilani, she leads Smart and Digital Manufacturing initiatives, developing industry-relevant curriculum with cutting edge experiential learning modules and learning factories. Her work bridges applied research and industrial practice, fostering innovation and workforce transformation in next-generation manufacturing.

Submission details

In the first instance a 300 word abstract is required, to be received by **1 April 2026.** Please read the guidelines here: https://www.academic-conferences.org/conferences/submission-information/

Submissions must be made using the online submission form at https://www.academic-conferences.org/conferences/ecel/ecel-abstract-submission/

If you have any questions about this track, please email Dr. Prakruthi Hareesh prakruthi.hareesh@pilani.bits-pilani.ac.in

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